

STEPHAN KWAPIS

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Marketing leader with 15+ years across credit union financial services, multi-channel agency work, and full P&L business ownership. Currently drives digital marketing strategy and execution at a Michigan credit union, with deep working knowledge of the credit union system, regulatory environment, and member-focused growth. Previously built and ran a multi-client marketing and creative agency for seven years, with full responsibility for hiring, team leadership, budget, vendor relationships, and client outcomes. Combines strategic planning and budget oversight with hands-on digital fluency (SEO, paid media, analytics, CRM, content, and brand) and the willingness to stay close to execution when it matters.

CORE COMPETENCIES

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|-----------------------------------|--|-------------------------------------|
| ▶ Marketing Strategy & Planning | ▶ Multi-Brand / Multi-Entity Marketing | ▶ Budget Management & ROI |
| ▶ Team Leadership & Mentorship | ▶ Digital Marketing & SEO | ▶ Paid Media (Google, Meta, OTT) |
| ▶ Marketing Analytics & Reporting | ▶ CRM & Marketing Automation | ▶ Brand Strategy & Voice |
| ▶ Content & Editorial Standards | ▶ Vendor & Agency Management | ▶ Credit Union & Financial Services |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

American 1 Credit Union *Jackson, MI*

Communications Specialist (Digital Marketing & Brand Strategy) 2024 – Present

- Drive digital marketing strategy and execution across the credit union's member-facing channels, contributing to integrated marketing planning that supports acquisition, retention, and product adoption across multiple business lines (auto loans, HELOC, credit, financial wellness).
- Plan, execute, and analyze multi-channel digital campaigns (Google, Meta, OTT, online banking app placements, email, search) and translate performance data into recommendations that shape ongoing strategy and budget allocation.
- Own end-to-end website strategy and optimization, including content architecture, SEO, conversion paths, and analytics, working cross-functionally with marketing, product, compliance, and IT.
- Develop campaign content and brand-aligned messaging across digital, email, and member communications, with attention to tone, clarity, grammatical accuracy, and consistency with credit union brand standards.
- Operate inside a financial services regulatory environment, balancing growth and conversion goals against compliance and brand integrity requirements.
- Contribute to quarterly marketing planning, including campaign roadmapping, brand initiatives, and event programming such as the Financial Wellness Reality Fair.
- Collaborate with external vendors and platform partners (SavvyMoney, LocalIQ, ad networks) to execute integrated campaigns and manage paid media performance.

Gumseat Productions *Holt, MI*

Founder / Owner 2017 – 2024

- Founded and operated a full-service marketing and creative studio for seven years, with full responsibility for strategy, P&L, hiring, team leadership, vendor management, and client outcomes.
- Directed marketing strategy and execution across multiple concurrent client brands, balancing distinct audiences, budgets, and business objectives, the same multi-entity coordination required across a credit union and its CUSOs.
- Developed and managed marketing budgets at the client and operational level, allocating resources across paid media, creative production, and vendor relationships to optimize ROI.
- Hired, trained, and led seasonal team members; established workflows, performance expectations, and quality standards that scaled output without sacrificing creative or brand integrity.
- Owned end-to-end execution across paid social, email, search, print, broadcast, and TV advertising, and built reporting practices that connected campaign activity to measurable client outcomes.
- Maintained vendor and agency relationships across print, media buying, and production partners across Michigan.

SunFrog Shirts *Gaylord, MI*

Art Director / Production Manager 2012 – 2017

- Led the in-house creative team and wholesale production unit at a high-volume e-commerce apparel company, with responsibility for output quality, brand consistency, team development, and operational efficiency.
- Managed performance reviews, training programs, and continuous-improvement initiatives that supported team growth and consistent execution at scale.
- Contributed to the UX redesign of the e-commerce platform, partnering with engineering and product on user-flow improvements that increased conversion.
- Established QA and brand-integrity standards across high-volume design and production output.

TECHNICAL & MARKETING TECHNOLOGY PROFILE

Digital & Analytics: Google Analytics (GA4), Search Console, Google Tag Manager, technical SEO, conversion tracking, custom reporting dashboards, A/B testing, KPI development

Paid Media & Channels: Google Ads, Meta Ads, Pinterest, OTT advertising, online banking app placements, email/CRM, SavvyMoney, LocalIQ

Marketing Technology: CRM platforms, marketing automation, email marketing, content management systems (WordPress, headless CMS), AI-assisted content and analytics workflows

Creative & Brand: Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Acrobat, Premiere, After Effects), brand systems, video production, conversion-focused creative direction

Web & Development: WordPress, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, Node.js, PostgreSQL; able to translate strategy into technical requirements and back

EDUCATION

Central Michigan University *Mt. Pleasant, MI*

B.A., Broadcasting (Minor: Communications) Graduated August 2008